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IFR: FACTS about Industrial Robots - You Tube Video +++

IFR: Five Million Robots now Operate in Factories Globally +++

IFR: Global Sales of Professional Service Robots Surge 24 Percent +++

IFR: Top Five Robot Trends 2026 +++

News

Global Sales of Professional Service Robots Surge 24%

117,000 Transport and logistics' robots lead as top application

Frankfurt, Sep 30, 2026 — Global shipments of professional service robots increased by 24% to almost 250,000 units in 2025, highlighting a successful shift to commercial automation. These findings are presented in the World Robotics 2026 Service Robots report by the IFR.

Five Million Robots now Operate in Factories Globally

World Robotics 2026 Report by IFR released

Frankfurt, Sep 24, 2026 — The global operational stock of industrial robots surged 9% to a record 5 million units in 2025. This was driven by an 11% jump in annual installations: Factories worldwide installed more than 600,000 new units over the year.

President's Report by Jane Heffner

Sep 24, 2026 — I am pleased to open my first President's Report with an overview of the latest World Robotics statistics, which we are publishing today.

Latest Blog Posts

When mobile robots call elevators

How M2X aims to standardize communication between mobile robots and infrastructure

Form Follows Function

The Pragmatism of Physical AI

Portrait of Mikell Taylor

One of 11 Women Shaping the Future of Robotics in 2026

Explore Our Case Studies

Breaking the high-mix bottleneck with intelligent automation

Collaborative Robotics in Textile Manufacturing

TIAGo Pro at CETRIKO

Breakthrough Robotic Grinding in Energy Storage Manufacturing

Estun helps global customers realize efficient and green production

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Topics and Definitions

Industrial Robots

The IFR's use of the term "industrial robot" is based on the definition of the ISO: an "automatically controlled, reprogrammable multipurpose manipulator programmable in three or more axes"

Learn More

Service Robots

The International Organization for Standardization defines a “service robot” as a ″robot in personal use or professional use that performs useful tasks for humans or equipment”

Learn More

Robotics Research

The IFR fosters links between the robotics industry and institutes. Our members engage in an intensive exchange on new technologies and emerging robots at the International Symposium on Robotics ISR

Learn More

Position Papers

Information and IFR opinion on topical issues regarding robots and automation

Learn More

Case Studies

Case Studies of Industrial and Service Robots. Robots in action can be found everywhere. Robot Manufacturers give examples of robot applications in different industries

Learn More

Robots and Sustainability

Which of UN′s 17 Sustainability Development Goals can be met with the support of robots?

Learn More

“I believe that robots and related technologies are important elements that enrich people’s lives while reducing the burden of their daily work. Several decades ago, the scenes of humans and robots sharing the common space and working together was considered a fantasy world, but such a day is not too far off.

IFR will take the lead for the people to be ready to enjoy such a world.”

Takayuki Ito - past IFR President and Standing Advisor & Chief Technical Advisor at FANUC Japan

″IFR is a well recognized organization which unites national robot associations, academia and manufacturers all over the world. To join IFR will let us know the latest statistics and information, to have the channel to present our ideas and thoughts in front of global peers. We hope to have more opportunities for international cooperation and promote the high-speed and healthy development of the robotics industry.″

Wei You - IFR Executive Board member and CEO and Chairman of EFORT group

″SCHUNK is a member of the International Federation of Robotics to stay updated on global trends, policies, and advancements in robotics. Membership allows contribution to shaping standards, policies, and fostering robot adoption worldwide.″

Milton Guerry - Chair IFR Marcom Committee; President of SCHUNK US

″As the CEO of PAL Robotics, I am proud to bring our 20+ years of pioneering expertise in service robotics to the International Federation of Robotics (IFR). Serving as the Chair of Service Robotics, it′s an honor to collaborate with industry leaders. Together, we′re committed to shaping a future where robotics and human society coexist beneficially, driving innovation and enhancing the quality of life globally.″

Francesco Ferro - Chair IFR Service Robot Group and CEO of PAL Robotics

"IFR is a unique international association having members from groups, companies and research institutes from around the world who are involved in robotics. IFR widely offers useful data, opportunities and other benefits not only to its members, but also to the world at large. There are high expectations that IFR will enhance the synergy and mutual support among all its members to become drivers to energetically establish a sustainable society."

Kenji Yamaguchi - past IFR Vice President and Representative Director, President and CEO of FANUC Corporation, Japan

"Joining IFR is a source of pride, the sharing expertise of the worldwide members is key to progress rapidly in the deployment of robotics, build up a powerful innovation ecosystem and drive excellent research. IFR strengths are the possibility to create new opportunities of partnerships, to promote the transfer of knowledge in order to shrink the distances between robotics world and the society and the excellent research networks".

Sandro Santamaria - IFR General Assembly Member and CEO, ROBOTECO Spa, Italy

"IFR brings opportunity to network and engage with other professionals and entrepreneurs in the field of robotics to together ensure both that more companies and more people benefit from adopting technologies. I believe we are witnessing one of the greatest technological shifts in the history of mankind, during which Robotics, AI and related technologies have the potential to transform every industry and aspect of our lives within the next decade."

Marina Bill - Vice Chair IFR Industrial Robot Suppliers Committee and Global Head of Marketing & Sales, ABB Management Services Ltd.

Established in 1987, IFR has brought together the international robotics players in more than 20 countries. It is a unique platform for sharing information and exchanging ideas, thus contributing to the dynamic development of the robotics around the world. The role of IFR is becoming more and more important for further global development of robotics in the future. CRIA is proud to be part of this international robotics family.

Xiaogang Song - IFR Executive Board Member and Secretary General, China Robotics Industry Alliance (CRIA)

"The International Federation of Robotics is here to provide a reliable and highly trained professional network for the robotics community. By sponsoring the International Symposium on Robotics (ISR), the IFR stands as a major driver for researchers and engineers from around the globe, allowing them to present their pioneering works in service and industrial robotics."

Professor Alexander Verl - Chairman IFR Research Committee and Head of Institute for Control Engineering of Machine Tools and Manufacturing Units / University of Stuttgart

"What I have learned from IFR: The market data on new technologies and trends provided by the IFR are essential for anyone involved in robotics. The IFR meetings have been tremendously beneficial for bringing together industry and academia, and providing invaluable networking opportunities."

Jong-Oh Park - IFR Executive Board Member and Professor School of Mechanical Engineering, Chonnam National University

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Events

MTM & Robotics 2026 International Conference

October 15- October 17, 2026

Joint International Conference

GREx Global Tech Expo 2026

October 22- October 25, 2026

ROBONEXT

December 02- December 04, 2026

European Robotics Forum 2027

March 02- March 04, 2027

18th European Robotics Forum 2027

Automate 2027

May 10- May 13, 2027

The latest in robotics, machine vision, AI, motion control, and more

automatica

June 22- June 25, 2027

trade fair for smart automation and robotics

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World Robotics - Industrial Robots: Global Robot Demand in Factories Doubles Over 10 Years

The new World Robotics 2025 statistics on industrial robots showed 542,000 robots installed in 2024 - more than double the number 10 years ago. Annual installations topped 500,000 units for the fourth straight year. Asia accounted for 74% of new deployments in 2024, compared with 16% in Europe and 9% in the Americas.

Products

Free Downloads

World Robotics - Service Robots See Global Growth Boom

In 2024, worldwide sales of professional service robots grew by 9%, medical robots by 91%, and service robots for consumer use by 11%. More than 199,000 units for professional service robots and close to 16,700 units of medical robots sold were registered by the IFR Statistical Department.

Products

Free Downloads

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Services

Newsletter Registration

The IFR Newsletter - published quarterly - informs about sector relevant news - press releases, in-depth blogs, positioning papers and case studies on robot use. In addition, we inform about upcoming events, and new IFR members. Each newsletter highlights a report by the current IFR president. Please register for an automatic supply.

Newsletter 3/2026

Newsletter 2/2026

Newsletter 1/2026

Newsletter 4/2025

Contact

IFR Secretariat

The General Secretariat is responsible for the daily management of IFR and the coordination of all major activities, events and collaboration. The General Secretariat handles all questions regarding IFR membership.

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IFR Statistical Department

The Statistical Department collects and interprets market relevant data on global robot installations. It handles requests regarding IFR statistics and the World Robotics report.

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